

REFERENCE NOTE

Where Enquiries Go Quiet

Five places an enquiry stops moving. Four of them leave nothing behind.

Drawn from clinics across Bangalore we have messaged and tested ourselves, as a patient would. The general shape, not a claim about any one clinic.

THE FIVE POINTS

An enquiry rarely fails loudly. It stops at one of five points. The useful question is not which one, but whether anyone could tell you afterwards that it happened.

LEAVES A RECORD SOMEONE COULD CHECK LATER

- ✓ A price was quoted. The number sits in the chat, whether or not anyone ever went back to it.

LEAVES NOTHING BEHIND

- It arrived when nobody was free to type. Nothing anywhere records that a message landed and waited.
- It got an answer, but nobody asked anything back. What the person needed was never written down.
- A slot was offered and never confirmed. Nothing separates discussed from booked.
- Someone said they would come back after the festival. Whoever heard it either remembers, or does not.

Four of the five leave no trace at all. These are not gaps anyone is failing to fix. They are gaps nobody can see, so no amount of working harder makes them show up.

WHY IT STAYS INVISIBLE

None of the four appear in a monthly review, because there is nothing to review. They do not arrive as complaints either. Someone who never got an answer never became a patient, so no list anywhere holds their name.

SOMETHING WORTH CHECKING, WITH OR WITHOUT US

- Scroll back two weeks on the clinic's WhatsApp. Count the threads where the last message is the patient's.
- Then the ones where the last message is the clinic's. The first group never got an answer. The second was answered, then dropped.

What this is not: not a case for replacing anyone, and not an argument that patients should talk to a machine. All five happen in clinics with good people and full diaries, precisely because those people are busy with the patient in front of them.

The question underneath all five is the same. For any enquiry that went quiet last week, could anyone tell you which of the five it was?

If the honest answer is that it lives in someone's memory, that is not a failing. It only means the record does not exist yet.